



▲ BORCHARDT C93

Date 1894

Origin Germany

Weight 1.66kg (3¾lb)

Barrel 16.5cm (6½in)

Calibre 7.65mm

The C93 was the first successful self-loading pistol. For its locking mechanism, it drew on the design of Maxim's machine-guns, which Borchardt's employer, Loewe, was producing under licence in Berlin.

Trigger

Butt houses removable eight-round magazine



Blade fore sight

▲ MAUSER C96

Date 1896–1930s

Origin Germany

Weight 1.15kg (2½lb)

Barrel 14cm (5½in)

Calibre 7.63mm Mauser

Despite shortcomings, chief among which was its complexity, the Mauser C96, chambered for a particularly effective and popular round, was one of the most successful designs of its day.



► BERGMANN NO. 3

Date 1896

Origin Germany

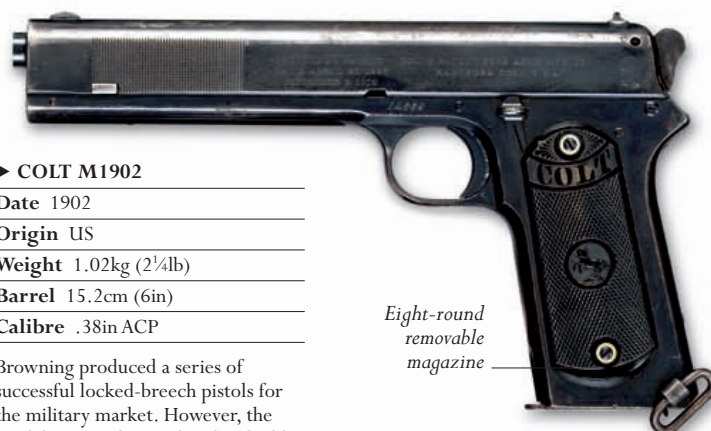
Weight 880g (31oz)

Barrel 11.2cm (4½in)

Calibre 6.5mm Bergmann

The Louis Schmeisser-designed "No. 3" was amongst the simplest of pistols, with a "blowback" breech and a small-capacity fixed magazine. The spent case was ejected by gas pressure alone.

Fixed five-round magazine



► COLT M1902

Date 1902

Origin US

Weight 1.02kg (2¼lb)

Barrel 15.2cm (6in)

Calibre .38in ACP

Browning produced a series of successful locked-breech pistols for the military market. However, the Model 1902 – designed with a double-link mechanism and chambered for a lighter round – was not as popular.

Eight-round removable magazine



Barrel locking-lug

Hammer (or "hahn")

► STEYR "HAHN" M1911

Date 1911

Origin Austria

Weight 980g (34½oz)

Barrel 12.7cm (5in)

Calibre 7.63mm Mannlicher

This was the first successful locked-breech semi-automatic pistol Steyr produced. Its weakness was its non-removable magazine, which was charged from above using a clip. This version was used by the Chilean armed forces.

► WEBLEY MODEL 1910

Date 1910–30s

Origin UK

Weight 960g (33¾oz)

Barrel 12.7cm (5in)

Calibre .38in

Better known for revolvers, Webley also produced semi-automatic pistols. The unsophisticated Model 1910 was the most successful, and was adopted by the British Royal Navy and the Royal Flying Corps.